Curriculum Vitae

Personal Information

Name: Karen Hoffmann (Kuribayashi)
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Address: Stader Landstr. 4, 27711 Osterholz-Scharmbeck, Germany
Nationality: Japanese
Date of Birth: 19/04/1997 in Kanagawa

Education

10/2021 – 04/2024 **Master of Science in Media Informatics**
University of Bremen, Bremen, Germany
- Master's thesis on storytelling visualization for the effective use of transition in scientific visualization with relationships among vehicle technologies
- GPA 1.59

09/2016 – 05/2021 **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science**
University of Calgary, Calgary, Canada
- Concentrated in Human-Computer Interaction and minored in Management and Society
- Designed and developed an iOS scanner application for a grocery store chain, and received sponsorship with MNP and Calgary CO-OP
- Awarded the IDEAS Fund from the Faculty of Science
- Served as a Teaching Assistant for 3 undergraduate Japanese language courses

09/2013 – 06/2016 **High School**
Yale Secondary, Abbotsford, Canada

Professional Experience

05/2024 – 09/2025 **Data Scientist, Bochum (Germany)**
Center for Advanced Internet Studies gGmbH
- Designed and implemented a research study on citizen acceptance of smart city initiatives funded by the Volkswagen Foundation
- Organized events for user studies
- Conducted qualitative and quantitative data analysis using MAXQDA, Excel, and R
- Translated outcomes into peer-reviewed publications, conference papers, posters and presentation slides

- Presented findings to stakeholders, interdisciplinary audiences and at the IST 2025 conference

07/2023 – 03/2024
German Aerospace Center

Student Research Assistant, Stuttgart (Germany)

- Conducted research and data collection on relevant technical and industry topics to support ongoing research
- Prepared, and organized research data and Excel for use by senior researchers
- Researched, designed and developed an Oracle APEX application with SQL databases for interactive vehicle technology forecasting as part of the master's thesis

09/2022 – 05/2024
SOCIUM Research Center

Student Assistant, Bremen (Germany)

- Developed a Web application in Flask for comparing sociological literature to improve interface usability accessibility through user-centered design
- Maintained and enhanced API documentation on GitHub

Language and Skill

Languages	Japanese: Mother Tongue English: Fluent German: B1 (Currently in B1 program)
Skills	Microsoft 365 (Excel, Word, PowerPoint): Proficient Google Workspace (Docs, Sheets, Slides): Proficient Adobe Creative Suite: Advanced Research and information gathering Presentation preparation and documentation Organization and coordination Data management and data analysis Operational and analytical problem solving Written and verbal communication in international and interdisciplinary environments

Publication

Heger, P . & Kuribayashi, K. Imagining Sustainable Urban Infrastructure: A Participatory Approach to Understanding Citizens' Mental Models of Heat Grids. Presented at IST 2025.
Kaur Betz, P ., Kuribayashi, K., et al. Designing Interactive Technology Roadmaps: A Visual Analytics Approach. Presented at CHIIR 2025.

Osterholz-Scharmbeck, 24.09.2026